

Worksheet 5: Australia as a global citizen - giving aid

In the year 2012-13, the Australian decided to give nearly 5.2 billion dollars in foreign aid. This equals about \$228 for every Australian citizen. Most of this money was promised for countries in the Asia-Pacific region. The largest recipient of Australian aid is Papua New Guinea.

Australia offers financial support to developing countries because:

- it provides *jobs* and experience for Australians who deliver 80% of our aid program
- it improves *security* in our region. This can be achieved by tackling problems such as disease, crime and illegal drug trafficking. Hopefully this will lead to stronger societies in our neighbouring countries and less chance of conflict within them.

The agency that manages Australia's funding for developing countries has been called *AusAid* since 1995. *AusAid* provides foreign aid in two main forms. The first, economic aid, deals with long-term plans that will help developing nations reach a greater level of independence. Some of these measures include:

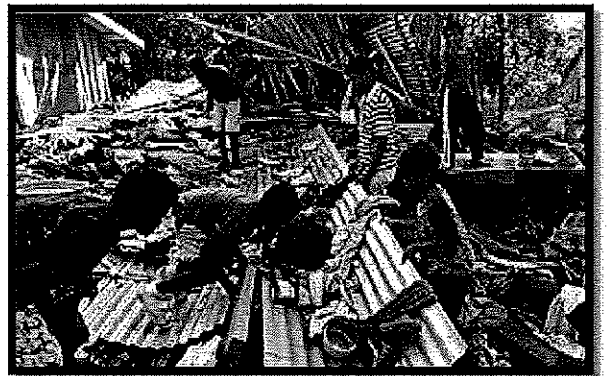
- *agricultural and rural development*
- *education*
- *health*
- *good government*
- *infrastructure development, which is basic services like education, transport and sewerage.*

The other type of foreign aid is *humanitarian*. This 'immediate' aid is in response to emergencies, such as natural disasters and communities recovering from internal conflict. An example of this type of aid was when Australia gave assistance to many Asian countries following the Boxing Day tsunami in 2004.

Imagine this scenario...

The emergency session of parliament has put forward 22 suggestions in response to the Asian tsunami. The budget for Australia's contribution is high but not unlimited. The list of suggestions are:

- body bags for the deceased
- builders, especially for hospitals, schools and mosques
- communication equipment
- electricity generators



Children hunt for clothes in the wreckage after a tsunami. Solomon Islands. Photo courtesy of Helen Rook



Shrouded bodies of the deceased Banda Aceh 2004.

- farming equipment, fertilisers and insecticides
- fishing boats and nets
- food packages
- free advertising for Asian tourism interests
- funding for a tsunami warning centre
- a Government-funded concert on New Year's Eve to raise money for relief efforts
- grief counsellors
- helicopters
- immunisation drugs
- medical teams, including doctors and nurses
- medicines
- military police
- pharmacists to disperse drugs
- road building teams
- tents and blankets
- training for Asian medical students
- transport and accommodation for 5000 refugees
- water purification plants.



Above: Burmese service members and civilian aid workers providing bottled water.



Haitian earthquake survivors wait to receive non-perishable goods from a Red Cross distribution site in Port-au-Prince, Haiti, Jan 25, 2010



Red Cross ship bringing aid after the 2004 Boxing Day tsunami. CC BY 2.0)

In pairs:

Your task is to choose the **TEN** most appropriate types of aid for **IMMEDIATE** assistance and then **justify** your choices.